

Active WebCam 8.3

The Roving Eye

There are surveillance applications aplenty, but Active WebCam is different. This easy-to-use application not only lets you use multiple cameras to monitor activity. You can also record the footage for later use.

Wizards guide you through the camera setup process. You can then choose to send video with audio to any computer on your network that has the app installed, soundless video to HTTP users, and screen captures to FTP servers.

Live audio and video can be broadcast to the PY Software Web server (subscription to Dynamic IP Service is necessary, which comes as part of the 30-day trial), and Active Webcam can be configured to set permissions for users

and groups, as also the maximum number of allowed visitors. For when the camera(s) detect(s) motion, it can be configured to sound an alarm, or e-mail the video footage / snaps it records, or start broadcasting live images and videos.

So who can benefit? You can transmit live videos of your friends' reunion parties over the Internet. You can use it as a surveillance mechanism at your front door. Jewellers will benefit from the multi-camera capabilities: keep an eye on multiple customers at the same time! You can set it to monitor your children while you're away. Record simple video presentations... just use your imagination and think of more uses!



In addition to all the above, you can use the Tools menu in Active WebCam to create and design a Web page to where you post videos and stills. Two nifty applications come bundled:

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

a video player that can play captured videos in the native format, and a video editor that can convert captured videos to AVI with any installed compression, or to MPEG-1.

Active WebCam works with any camera detected by Windows. For \$29, this is a steal—no gripes!

Contact: PY Software
Web site: www.pysoft.com
Price: \$29 (Rs 1,300)

VirusBuster Professional 2006

Funky looks, basic functionality

This is an anti-virus program from Hungary... but don't let that put you off! Let's take a look at what it offers in comparison to other anti-viruses...

Post-installation, the first thing you see is the unconventional interface. There are no menus, and the icons are cartoonish! In addition, you end up going through multiple windows and clicks before actually scanning something.

VirusBuster Professional has the standard set of features—the main file scanner, a shield that looks at background processes, and an Outlook scanner. There is support for scanning network shares as well; the same interface is used for this.

Different levels of sensitivity are available for

each feature, and these can be altered by the user.

The Quarantine feature lets you scan the quarantine folder after a virus database update, and there's automated restoring of cleaned files. The updater lets you choose from different locations such as HTTP, FTP server, CD, etc.

Security features were kept in mind as well. You can set an administrator so other users don't tamper with the settings. The Rights Management lets you set permissions to the various components of the program.

CPU utilisation spiked between 30 and 50 per cent, but the memory consumption hovered around the 30 MB mark, which is pretty OK.

The help file is detailed, but is low on



screenshots. The downloadable PDF manual, however, has plenty of screenshots for every feature and menu.

VirusBuster Professional 2006 isn't a

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market leader among anti-virus software for sure. It doesn't come cheap either: Rs 1,400 for a year. For a similar price, there are plenty of other choices available. Most free anti-virus software sport smarter interfaces.

Contact: Karvid Technologies
Phone: 020-27641650
E-Mail: sanket@karvid.com
Web site: www.virusbuster.hu/en/
Price: Rs 1,400